City of Saint Paul

City Hall and Court House
15 West Kellogg Boulevard
Council Chambers - 3rd Floor
651-266-8560

Meeting Minutes

City Council

Council President Rebecca Noecker
Vice President Nelsie Yang
Councilmember Anika Bowie
Councilmember Molly Coleman
Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson
Councilmember Saura Jost
Councilmember HwaJeong Kim

Wednesday, July 22, 2026 | **3:30 PM** | **Council Chambers - 3rd Floor**

ROLL CALL

Meeting started at 3:31 PM

Present 7 - Councilmember Rebecca Noecker, Councilmember Nelsie Yang, Councilmember HwaJeong Kim, Councilmember Anika Bowie, Councilmember Saura Jost, Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson and Councilmember Molly Coleman

COMMUNICATIONS & RECEIVE/FILE

1 AO 26-44 Establishing one (1) new project through the Neighborhood STAR Year-Round Program as adopted via City Council Resolution #- RES 26-1052.

Received and Filed

2 AO 26-45 Amending ESG project budgets: funding for 2025-26 Emergency Solutions Grant activities administered by Ramsey County per the Joint Powers Agreement approved via RES 19-2110.

Received and Filed

CONSENT AGENDA
Items listed under the Consent Agenda will be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. If discussion on an item is desired, the item will be removed from the Consent Agenda for separate consideration.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Council President Noecker stated that Item 13 would be taken separately.

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Consent Agenda adopted as amended

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

3 RES 26-1021 Approving the City's cost for Demolition of Vacant, Nuisance and/or Hazardous Structure from the month of June 2026, and setting date of Legislative Hearing for August 25, 2026 and City Council public hearing for September 23, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. J2608C, Assessment No. 262007)

Adopted

4 RES 26-1080 Establishing the rate of pay for the classification of Accounting Director, Grade 028, EG 09, SPSO.

Laid over to August 5, 2026

5 RES 26-1084 Establishing the rate of pay for Public Works Supervisor II, Solid Waste, Manual and Maintenance Supervisors - Employee Group 10, Grade 038.

Laid over to August 5, 2026

6 RES 26-1094 Authorizing the City to enter into an agreement with the Metropolitan Council and Ramsey County for replacement of traffic signal controllers and related work on the Metro Green Line along University Avenue.

Adopted

7 RES 26-1139 Authorizing the Department of Public Works to enter into a grant agreement with the Ramsey-Washington Metro Watershed District for the enhanced street sweeping stewardship grant to perform additional street sweeping within the Ramsey-Washington Metro Watershed District boundaries.

Adopted

8 RES 26-1143 Approving an Auto Repair Garage New Location license application (License ID #DSIBLAUTO- 000615-2026) for Discount Tire Company of MN Inc d/b/a Discount Tire for the premises located at 1350 University Ave W.

Adopted

9 RES 26-1144 Approving the application for change of ownership to the Liquor On Sale, Liquor On Sale - Sunday, Liquor On Sale - 2 AM Closing, Entertainment (A), and Gambling Location licenses (License ID #DSIBLLIQ-000644-2026) now held by Bear Down Holdings LLC d/b/a The Victorian for the premises located at 859 Thomas Ave.

Adopted

10 RES 26-1146 Amending Council File RES 26-890 to add the MnDOT agreement number and update the grant amount.

Adopted

11 RES 26-1160 Approving the Mayor's appointments of Caitlyn Brady, Sam Adams, Esmae Heveron, Tou Fang, Trever Harwell, and reappointment of Nate

Nins to the Neighborhood STAR Board.

Adopted

12 RES 26-1179 Approving the use of grant funds through the Ward 3 Neighborhood STAR Year-Round Program for Presbyterian Homes Foundation.

Adopted

FOR DISCUSSION

13 RES 26-1197 Recognizing Community Health Workers day in the City of Saint Paul.

Councilmember Johnson gave remarks.

Sunny Ainley from the Minnesota Community Health Worker Alliance gave remarks.

Mark Phillips from the Minnesota Community Health Worker Alliance gave remarks.

Johnson continued her remarks, read from the resolution, and moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

14 ABZA 25-3 Considering the appeal of Dominic Carchedi to a decision of the Board of Zoning Appeals denying a variance request to establish a 24-resident supportive housing facility on the property at 418 Sherburne Avenue. (Public hearing closed. Laid over from August 6, 2025)

David Eide from the Department of Safety and Inspections gave a staff report and answered councilmember questions.

Dan Stahley from the City Attorney's Office gave background information on the process.

Councilmember Bowie moved to deny the appeal.

Motion of intent is to deny the appeal

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

15 ABZA 25-5 Considering the appeal of Stronger Sober House to a decision of the Board of Zoning Appeals denying a variance request to establish a 11-resident supportive housing facility on the property at 519 Farrington Street. (Public hearing closed. Laid over from August 6, 2025)

David Eide from the Department of Safety and Inspections gave a staff report and answered councilmember questions.

Councilmember Bowie moved to deny the appeal.

Motion of intent is to deny the appeal

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

SUSPENSION ITEMS

RES 26-1158 Authorizing the City to renew its lease with Metropolitan State University for the Dayton's Bluff Library.

Councilmember Johnson spoke in favor and moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

RES 26-1223 Authorizing the proper City officials to enter into a Joint Powers Agreement with Ramsey County to exercise their common and cooperative powers to support the operation of emergency shelter facilities.

Councilmember Johnson spoke in favor and moved approval.

Council President Noecker spoke in favor.

Johnson answered clarifying questions from Councilmember Bowie.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

ORDINANCES

An ordinance is a city law enacted by the City Council. It is read at three separate council meetings and becomes effective after passage by the Council and 30 days after publication in the Saint Paul Pioneer Press. Public hearings on ordinances are generally held at the second reading.

Final Adoption

16 Ord 26-32 Amending Appendix C of the Legislative Code relating to Northern States Power, D/B/A Xcel Energy, Electric Franchise.

Councilmember Jost moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

17 Ord 26-33 Amending Appendix B of the Legislative Code relating to Northern States Power, D/B/A Xcel Energy, Gas Franchise.

Councilmember Jost moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

First Reading

18 Ord 26-27 Administrative Ordinance placing the classification titled Deputy City Clerk in the unclassified service pursuant to Section 12.03.2(H) of the City of Saint Paul Charter (must be approved by Civil Service Commission after adoption by City Council but prior to Mayor signature).

Jay Willms, City Council Director of Operations, gave a staff report and answered councilmember questions.

Laid over to August 5, 2026 for Second Reading

19 Ord 26-31 Amending Section 224.05(c) of the Legislative Code to eliminate the City's provisional 90-day minimum wage rate in the City of Saint Paul for workers between the ages of 14 and 17.

Stephanie Boehmer from the Department of Human Rights and Equal Employment Opportunity gave a staff report and answered councilmember questions.

Councilmember Coleman spoke in favor.

Laid over to August 5, 2026 for Second Reading

PUBLIC HEARINGS
Live testimony is limited to two minutes for each person. See below for optional ways to testify.

20 Ord 26-35 Amending Chapter 65 of the Legislative Code pertaining to golf courses.

Councilmember Jost moved Version 2. Approved 7-0.

Jost moved to close the public hearing and lay over for one week.

Amended and laid over to August 5, 2026 for Final Adoption

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

21 Ord 26-36 Adding Chapter 86.13 to the Administrative Code to require City Council approval of Mixed Municipal Solid Waste contracts.

John Purdy, resident, spoke during the public hearing.

Council President Noecker moved to close the public hearing and lay over for one week.

Laid over to August 5, 2026 for Final Adoption

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

22 RES PH 26-150 Amending the financing and spending plans in the Department of Public Works Capital Budget to transfer Municipal State Aid (MSA) funding into the Wabasha Bridge Rehabilitation Project.

Councilmember Coleman moved approval

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

23 RES PH 26-151 Amending the financing and spending plans in the Department of Public Works Capital Budget for the University Avenue Street Reconstruction Project.

Councilmember Bowie moved approval

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

24 RES PH 26-155 Approving the application of the Department of Parks and Recreation for a sound level variance in order to present amplified sound for a National Night Out event on Tuesday, August 4, 2026, at 271 Mackubin Street - Martin Luther King Recreation Center.

Councilmember Bowie moved approval

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

25 RES PH 26-156 Approving the application of Dual Citizen Brewing Company for a sound level variance in order to present amplified sound for a Backyard Blues Fest event on Friday, August 7, and Saturday, August 8, 2026, at 725 Raymond Avenue - Dual Citizen Brewing.

Councilmember Coleman moved approval

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

LEGISLATIVE HEARING DISCUSSION ITEMS

26 RLH TA 26-125 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 720 COTTAGE AVENUE EAST. (File No. 2604T, Assessment No. 269003)

Marcia Moermond, Legislative Hearing Officer, described how there was no motion to act on the item the previous week due to a disruption.

Councilmember Kim moved approval

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

34 RLH SAO 26-50 Making finding on the appealed of Gary Grimes to a nuisance abatement ordered for 314 WYOMING STREET EAST in Council File RLH SAO 26-46. (Public hearing closed and laid over from August 19, 2026)

Marcia Moermond, Legislative Hearing Officer, gave a staff report.

Gary Grimes, appellant, spoke during the public hearing.

Council President Noecker moved to close the public hearing. Approved 7-0.

Noecker expressed desire to grant to August 12, 2026 for compliance.

Moermond asked that the public hearing be continued to August 19, 2026, so that a finding could be made on that deadline being met.

Noecker moved to grant to August 12, 2026 for compliance and continue the public hearing to August 19, 2026.

Public hearing continued to August 19, 2026

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

LEGISLATIVE HEARING CONSENT AGENDA

Items listed under the Consent Agenda will receive a combined public hearing and be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. Items may be removed from the Consent Agenda for a separate public hearing and discussion if desired.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Legislative Hearing Consent Agenda adopted as amended

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

27 RLH VO 26-29 Appeal of Lawrence Lee, Occupant, to a Notice of Condemnation and Order to Remain Vacant at 342 BATES AVENUE, UNIT 2.

Adopted

28 RLH SAO 26-55 Appeal of Tami Richardson to a Summary Abatement Order at 1547 CARROLL AVENUE.

Adopted

29 RLH SAO 26-57 Appeal of Katherine Werner to a Tall Grass and Weeds Order at 2177 FAIRMOUNT AVENUE.

Adopted

30 RLH SAO 26-54 Appeal of Jane Foster to a Summary Abatement Order at 1312 SCHEFFER AVENUE. (July 21, 2026 Legislative Hearing)

Public hearing continued to August 5, 2026

31 RLH SAO 26-56 Appeal of Thomas Turbes to a Summary Abatement Order and Vehicle Abatement Order at 2203 SELBY AVENUE.

Adopted

32 RLH VBR 26-12 Appeal of Gomaa Elzamel to a Vacant Building Registration Requirement at 838 THIRD STREET EAST.

Adopted

33 RLH VBR 26-13 Appeal of Jeanne Elizabeth Aura to a Vacant Building Registration Notice

and Notice of Condemnation and Order to Remain Vacant at 2051 THIRD STREET EAST.

Adopted

ADJOURNMENT

Meeting ended at 4:30 PM

City Council meetings are open for in person attendance, but the public may also comment on public hearing items in writing. Any comments and materials submitted by 12:00 pm of the day before the meeting will be attached to the public record and available for review by the City Council. Comments may be submitted as follows:

Written public comment on public hearing items can be submitted to Contact-Council@ci.stpaul.mn.us or CouncilHearing@ci.stpaul.mn.us. Live testimony will be taken in person in the Council Chambers.

Council Meeting Information
The City Council is paperless which saves the environment and reduces expenses. The agendas and Council files are all available on the Web (see below). Council members use mobile devices to review the files during the meeting. Using a mobile device greatly reduces costs since most agendas, including the documents attached to files, are over 1000 pages when printed.

Web
Meetings are available on the Council's website. Email notification and web feeds (RSS) of newly released minutes, agendas, and meetings are available by subscription. Visit www.stpaul.gov/council for meeting videos and updated copies of the agendas, minutes, and supporting documents.

Cable
Meetings are live on St Paul Channel 18 and replayed at various times. Check your local listings.